What actually went right last week

The 5 stories readers chose, week of 6 October

Zoom out: In 13th and 14th century Western Europe, more than 10 people in every 100,000 were murdered each year - in Italy as many as 70. Today the rate is about 1. (Our World in Data, from Eisner's historical series)

Verified sources · published daily



Retired teacher Jim Crouch has grown and given away 10,000 oak seedlings across Southern California, opening a sixth nursery to help replant fire-scarred Altadena.

What it proves: The new La Canada High School nursery will supply oak seedlings directly to Altadena residents rebuilding after the Eaton fire.



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Ahmed and Rifat Ali's home, condemned after they lost £72,000 to an unsafe extension, was rebuilt by more than 150 tradespeople and volunteers on BBC's DIY SOS, with cameras, visual fire and doorbell alerts and color changing lights built in for their deaf family.

Stanford scientists reversed cartilage loss and blocked arthritis in mice by inhibiting a single aging-related protein, and human knee cartilage samples began growing new tissue in response.

What it proves: Human cartilage taken during knee replacement surgery responded to the same treatment by producing new, functional cartilage.



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All 32 patients in the NEOPRISM-CRC trial stayed free of bowel cancer recurrence for 33 months after a nine week course of pembrolizumab before surgery, far beating the 25% relapse rate expected with standard chemotherapy.

What it proves: Blood tests tracking tumor DNA could let doctors identify which patients can safely skip extra chemotherapy after surgery.



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Ukraine has expanded free hot school lunches to every grade 1 to 11 student, now feeding roughly 3 million children daily, with kitchens in frontline Sumy region cooking through air raid sirens and blackouts.

What it proves: A diesel generator at Romny School No. 7 shows how a single kitchen can keep cooking through Russian strikes on the power grid.

All five stories are linked in the post text above.

“Alone we can do so little; together we can do so much.”

Helen Keller

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